

SpeechPilot — Manual

Dictate instead of typing: what you say goes into the field the cursor sits in. This manual covers everything the extension does — from the first click to macros, the bar and licences.

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1. Getting started

Switching on

Open the website you want to write on and click the SpeechPilot icon in the Chrome toolbar. The microphone button appears at the bottom right of the page. Clicking the icon again hides it.

SpeechPilot is only active on the tab you switched it on in. A new tab needs a new click.

Allowing the microphone

The first time you switch on, Chrome asks for the microphone. The prompt is at the top, in the address bar — answer with **Allow**. Without it there is no dictation. The permission then stays, and it is requested by SpeechPilot itself, not by the website.

If you clicked **Block** by mistake: click the lock or slider icon on the left of the address bar and allow the microphone there.

Pinning the icon

If the icon is not visible, click the puzzle piece at the top right of Chrome and pin SpeechPilot.

Opening the settings

Right-click the SpeechPilot icon → **Options**. That is where all the tabs live: settings, macros, emoji, replacements, bar, licence and this help.

2. Dictating

How it goes

1. Click into the field you want to write in — the cursor has to be blinking in it.
2. Click the microphone button or press `Ctrl` + `Shift` + `Y`.
3. Speak. The text appears in the field as you go.
4. Click again, or press the shortcut, to switch the microphone off.

Text always goes into the field the cursor sits in. Click into another field in between and SpeechPilot carries on writing there.

Enter

While text is still being processed, SpeechPilot holds the Enter key back so half a message never goes out. Hence the rule of thumb: **the first Enter commits the sentence, the second sends it**. When nothing is pending, Enter works as usual straight away.

Capitals

At the start of a sentence, after `. ! ?` and after a line break, the next word is capitalised. SpeechPilot does that on its own, in every licence tier.

Password fields

Dictation never writes into password or payment fields. The attempt is refused with a short notice.

Where it works

In ordinary input fields, text areas and most chat editors. Not on Chrome's own pages (`chrome://...`, the Web Store) or in the PDF viewer — Chrome lets no extension write there.

3. Speaking punctuation

These words are turned into characters as you dictate. They are built in and work in every tier, including the free version.

Spoken	Written
full stop / period	.
comma	,
question mark	?
exclamation mark / exclamation point	!
colon	:
semicolon	;
hyphen	-
dash	–
open bracket / close bracket, open parenthesis / close parenthesis	()
open quote / close quote	“ ”
new line	line break
new paragraph	blank line

The words follow the recognition language (Settings → Recognition language): dictating in German you say Komma, in Spanish coma. The list for the selected language is shown under **Replacements**. Your own entries there take precedence over the built-in ones.

Spacing is handled for you: no space before . , ! ? : ;) and none after (or a line break.

4. Settings

Every switch in the first tab takes effect immediately, with no saving.

Setting	What it does
Interface language	The language of the settings page and of the buttons on the website: German, English, Spanish, or "same as the browser". Takes effect at once and has nothing to do with recognition.
Recognition language	The language you speak. Available: German (Germany, Austria, Switzerland), English (US, UK), French, Spanish, Italian, Dutch, Polish, Portuguese and Turkish. A change takes effect the next time you switch the microphone on, not mid-sentence.
Replace ß with ss	Swiss spelling. Applies to macros and bar texts as well.
Capitalise after an emoji	An emoji usually ends a sentence. Turn it off if you often use emoji mid-sentence.
Show the microphone button on the page	With it hidden, everything runs through the toolbar icon or the keyboard shortcut.
Show the macro bar on the page	Shows the most recently used macro per letter group. The bar can be dragged.
Keyboard shortcut	The default is Ctrl + Shift + Y . Chrome manages shortcuts itself, so "change" takes you to chrome://extensions/shortcuts .
Backup	Exports and imports everything in one file — see Backup .

5. Replacements Standard

What you say on the left is written on the right. Made for technical terms, proper names and anything recognition keeps getting wrong.

Adding one

1. Open the **Replacements** tab and click **Add row**.
2. The spoken word on the left, the text that should appear on the right.
3. **Save** — changes only apply after that.

Worth knowing

- **Whole words only.** "house" does not replace the first five letters of "houseboat".
- **Umlauts and case don't matter.** "für" and "fuer" hit the same entry.
- Several words are fine too: "kind regards" → a whole sign-off.
- The built-in punctuation is listed at the bottom of the tab. You don't have to add it — and your own entry overrides it.

6. Emoji Standard

A spoken word becomes a character — useful for everything you cannot dictate.

1. **Emoji** tab → **Add row**.
2. The word on the left, for example thumbs. The character on the right: type it, open the Windows emoji keyboard with Windows + ., or pick one from the small selection under ▼.
3. **Save**.

Use words you would not otherwise dictate, or an emoji will turn up mid-sentence. Umlauts and case are ignored, as with replacements.

Whether the next word is capitalised after an emoji is set in the first tab.

7. Macros Complete

Macros are stored texts that answer to a short code: say the code, the whole text appears.

Codes

A code is a letter plus a number, for example **A1**. "A one" and "A 1" are recognised too — speech recognition writes numbers differently depending on its mood, so SpeechPilot checks every form. Number words up to twelve are turned into digits.

The settings page warns you when two codes sound the same when spoken — otherwise one would hide the other.

Creating them

- **In the settings: Macros** tab → **+ New macro**, enter code and text, **Save**.
- **As you go:** select text on the website and click the **+** next to the microphone button. SpeechPilot assigns the next free code.

Locking

So the same text does not go out twice when you misspeak, a used macro can be locked: off, 1, 5 or 15 minutes, 1 or 8 hours, or until reset. The timed options release the macro on their own; with "until reset" it stays locked until you release it under **Release locks** — either one letter group or all of them. The count of how often a macro has been used is kept.

Keeping the list in order

- **Search** and **first letter** filter the view; long lists are spread across pages.
- **Find duplicates** shows macros with identical text.
- **Delete shown** removes exactly what the current filter displays — that cannot be undone.

Saving and importing

Save macros and **Import macros** deal with macros only, separately from the general backup. On import, SpeechPilot asks what should happen:

Replace everything	The existing set is discarded.
Add	The file is added to what is there.
Add without duplicate texts	As above, but macros whose text already exists are left out.

For space reasons macros live on this computer only and do not travel through Chrome sync. Saving and importing is how they reach a second device.

The macro bar

Switched on in the first tab, it shows the most recently used macro per letter group and can be dragged around. **Shift**+click removes a group from the display.

Please note: some platforms have rules about whether and how pre-written texts may be used. Check the rules of the site you work on and follow them — that responsibility is yours.

8. The bar Complete

The bar is the button strip on the right edge of the page. The ☰ next to the microphone button shows and hides it. It holds text buttons and three drop-down lists.

Text buttons

- **Setting the text:** right-click the button. A button that is still empty opens the input on an ordinary click as well.
- **Using it:** click — the text goes into the linked field, or otherwise into the field the cursor sits in.

Linking a field

To make a button always write into the same field:

1. Shift + click the button or the list.
2. Click the field on the page. Esc cancels.

Alt + click releases the link again.

What is remembered is the field's **position**, not its name — websites change names all the time. If the page shows or hides a field, the positions shift and the link has to be set again. That is what "field no. 3 does not exist on this page" means.

The three lists

Occupations, hobbies and names are maintained in the settings, in the **Bar** tab: one entry per line. On saving, blank lines and duplicates are removed and everything is sorted alphabetically. The lists are shared by **all** profiles.

Profiles

Profiles are created in the bar itself, not in the settings. Each profile has its own texts and its own field links — one matching set per website. Renaming and deleting happen there too; deleting a profile removes its texts and links.

Space

The width of the bar can be dragged. **Make the page narrower** pushes the website aside instead of letting the bar sit on top of it.

9. Backup

In the first tab, **export** writes everything into one file: emoji, replacements, macros, the bar with its profiles, and all settings.

import replaces the entire set — you are asked first. If you only want to move macros, use the separate route in the Macros tab; when SpeechPilot recognises a pure macro file on import, it says so instead of wiping everything.

Make a backup before larger changes. It is also the way onto a second computer.

10. Licence

Dictation, the built-in punctuation and capitalisation are always included — even without a licence.

Tier	Includes
Free version	Dictation, built-in punctuation, capitalisation.
Standard	Plus your own replacements and your own emoji words.
Complete	Plus macros and the bar on the page.

Unlocking

Enter the key from the email you got after buying into the **Licence** tab and click **Unlock**. The key stays on this device and is re-checked at most once a day.

Without a connection

If the licence server cannot be reached, the last confirmed tier keeps working for another **14 days**. Only after that does it fall back to the free version, until the next check succeeds.

Changing device

Every key has a limited number of activations; the count is shown in the Licence tab. **Remove licence** frees the slot again — the same key can then be entered on another computer. If the server was unreachable at that moment, the slot is freed at the next opportunity.

What happens to locked content

Nothing is lost. Macros and bar texts stay stored, they are simply not used without the matching tier. After unlocking they are available immediately, with no need to reload the page.

11. Privacy

- Recognition is done by Chrome using Google's speech recognition — as in most dictation extensions.
- It runs in a shielded part of the extension, not in the website: the page sees neither your audio nor the recognised text — only what is written into its input field.
- SpeechPilot stores neither the recording nor the recognised text.
- Settings, replacements and emoji live in Chrome sync; macros stay local to this device.
- No account, no sign-in. The only thing that leaves your computer is the licence check, at most once a day.

The full statement is at speechpilot.vip/en/datenschutz.html.

12. When something goes wrong

What you see	Cause and remedy
No microphone button	SpeechPilot is not switched on for this tab (click the icon), or the button is hidden in the settings. On chrome:// pages and in the Web Store, Chrome allows no extension at all.
Nothing happens when you speak	The microphone has not been allowed — the prompt is in the address bar. Otherwise allow it via the icon on the left of the address bar.
Text lands in the wrong field	The cursor was elsewhere. Click into the field you want; for fixed targets, link the bar's buttons.
"Dictation does not write into password or payment fields"	That is intended.
"The text could not be inserted here"	The field refuses text from outside — usually a special editor. There, typing is the only way.
Enter does not send	Text was still being processed; that Enter committed it. The next one sends.
A macro does not come out	It is locked ("already used") — Release locks in the Macros

	tab. Or recognition wrote the code differently: look at the text in the field and add a second code if needed.
A bar button writes into the wrong place	The page showed or hid a field, so the position no longer matches. Set the link again with <code>Shift</code> +click.
Two microphone buttons	Can happen after an update while the tab was open. Reload the page.
Changes to replacements or emoji have no effect	Don't forget Save — unlike the switches in the first tab, the lists only apply afterwards.
"Not saved: the list is too long"	Chrome sync has a size limit. Shorten or split the entries.
Everything is locked	Check the Licence tab: is a key entered? When was it last checked? After 14 days without a connection the tier falls back.

13. Keys and clicks

Ctrl + Shift + Y	Turn dictation on and off (changeable in Chrome)
Click the toolbar icon	Show/hide SpeechPilot on this tab
Click the microphone button	Microphone on and off
+ next to the microphone button	Save selected text as a macro
≡ next to the microphone button	Show and hide the bar
Right-click a bar button	Change its text
Shift + click a button or list	Link a field
Alt + click a button	Release the link
Shift + click in the macro bar	Hide a group
Esc	Cancel linking
Windows + .	Windows emoji keyboard

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